

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 3

♥ 7

♦ 9 8 6 5 4 2

♣ J 9 4 3

♠ K 10 8

♥ A K 9 8 6 4

♦ —

♣ A K Q 7



♠ Q 9 7 4

♥ 10 3

♦ A Q 10 7

♣ 10 6 5

♠ A 6 5 2

♥ Q J 5 2

♦ K J 3

♣ 8 2

West

North

East

South

1♥

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♣

Pass

4♥

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♣

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by North

Lead: ♠ 7

Your partner's 3♥ is a limit-raise, 11-12 points with ♥ support.

What you want to know is whether partner holds the ♠ A. If you bid 4NT and he shows two Key-Cards all will be well, you will know they are the two missing Aces. But if he shows just 1 Key-Card you will be in the soup since you can't tell if that Key-Card is the useful ♠ A or the practically useless ♦ A. So you don't use RKCB, you use control-showing and bid 4♣. Partner says 4♥.

Partner would have control-bid ♦ s if he had the Ace. You may not think that helps but it does since now you can bid RKCB. You bid 4NT and he answers 5♣. What is your next bid?

It was a lot of work but you have figured out that partner holds 11-12 points including one Key-Card which must be the ♠ A. It looks like the slam is a good idea so you say 6♥.

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 3
♥ Q 9 2
♦ K Q 8 7 5
♣ 10 7 2

♠ K 8 6 5 2

♥ K J 10 7

♦ —

♣ A 9 8 3



♠ J

♥ A 6 5 4 3

♦ J 10 9 4

♣ 6 5 4

♠ A Q 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ K Q J

Your 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid, showing opening hand strength, at least 4 ♠s, and a singleton or void in ♦s. Partner bids 4NT.

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♣A. So do you bid 5♥?

No. You have two Key-Cards **AND** a void. So you bid 5NT. Partner bids 6♠.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	4 ♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5NT	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♦ K			

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 6 5 4

♥ Q 5

♦ 10 5 2

♣ A 7 2

♠ K Q J

♥ A 10 7 6

♦ A Q J

♣ Q J 9



♠ 3 2

♥ J 3 2

♦ 8 7 6 4 3

♣ 8 4 3

♠ A 10 8

♥ K 9 8 4

♦ K 9

♣ K 10 6 5

*West**North**East**South*

2NT

Pass

3♣

Pass

3♥

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♥

All Pass

5♥ by North

Lead: ♠ 3

Your partner's 2NT opener is 20-21 points and the 3♣ bid is Stayman.

You know of 33 points and you know of an 8-card ♥ fit. The math tells you that 6♥ should be a good slam but you might as well check Key-Cards, that's why the convention was invented. So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♥.

You say "Darn!" You are missing just one Key-Card, but you are also missing the trump Queen. And with partner holding only a 4-card suit that Queen might well win a trick. Knowing that at best the slam will depend on a trump finesse you pass 5♥.

Board 4

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 5 3 2
♥ 4 3
♦ J 9 6 2
♣ A 7 6 4

♠ A K Q J
♥ A J 10 7
♦ A 5
♣ K Q 10



♠ 10 9 8 6 4
♥ 6 2
♦ 10 8 3
♣ J 5 2

♠ 7
♥ K Q 9 8 5
♦ K Q 7 4
♣ 9 8 3

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, so you bid 5♣. Partner bids the ♥ slam.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			
Lead: ♣A			

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 2
 ♥ Q 10 3
 ♦ 9 7 6
 ♣ J 7 5 4

♠ A Q J 7 5 3

♥ 6 5

♦ A 4 3

♣ 8 2



♠ 6 4

♥ J 7 2

♦ J 10 5 2

♣ A 10 9 3

♠ K 10

♥ A K 9 8 4

♦ K Q 8

♣ K Q 6

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♠	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			
6 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♦ J			

The bidding has been as shown.

Your partner has shown a minimum opening hand, but with 6 ♠s. You are happy with the 8-card trump fit but need to know about Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner answers 5 ♠ and it is your bid again.

Partner has two Aces and the ♠Q. That should be all he needs to make slam so you bid 6 ♠.